

Solving systems of equations with the elimination method



- 1 Consider the following linear equations:

$$\begin{aligned}3x + 7y &= -6 \\ 2x - y &= -17\end{aligned}$$

- a What number should the second equation be multiplied by to eliminate y ?
 - b Eliminate y and hence find the value of x that satisfies both equations.
 - c Substitute the x value to find the value of y that satisfies both equations.
- 2 Consider the following linear equations:

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{2x}{5} + \frac{3y}{5} &= -\frac{7}{5} \\ -\frac{1}{4} \left(-5x + \frac{5y}{9} \right) &= \frac{5}{9}\end{aligned}$$

- a Write the new equations after the fractional coefficients have been changed to integer coefficients and simplified.
 - b Eliminate y and hence find the value of x that satisfies both equations.
- 3 Consider the following linear equations:

$$\begin{aligned}-8x - y &= 0 \\ -5x + 3y &= 6\end{aligned}$$

To solve this system using the elimination method, first multiply both sides of the first equation by 3 and then add the resulting equation to the second equation.

- a Write the new equation formed from the above procedure.
 - b Find the x and y values that satisfy both equations.
- 4 When we solve a system of equations using the elimination method, how do we know when there is no solution?

5 For each of the following systems of linear equations:



- i Find the number of solutions that satisfy both equations.
- ii State whether the system of equations is dependent, consistent or inconsistent.

a $7x + 3y = 4$
 $14x + 6y = 8$

b $7x + 3y = 5$
 $28x + 12y = 30$

6 Consider the following linear equations:

$$\frac{4x}{5} + \frac{3y}{5} = 4$$

$$8x - 3y = 5$$

State the operation required to change the fractional coefficients to integer coefficients in the first equation.

7 Explain how to eliminate the variable y in the following systems of equations:

a $\frac{1}{7}x + \frac{4}{7}y = 7$
 $\frac{1}{2}x + \frac{1}{3}y = 5$

b $2x - 1.8y = 5.9$
 $0.65x + 0.07y = -0.02$

8 Solve the following systems of equations:

a $7x - 4y = 15$
 $7x + 5y = 60$

b $-6x - 2y = 46$
 $-30x - 6y = 246$

c $-5x + 16y = 82$
 $25x - 4y = 122$

d $x + \frac{5}{4}y = \frac{9}{4}$
 $\frac{3}{5}x + y = \frac{7}{5}$

e $-\frac{x}{4} + \frac{y}{5} = 8$
 $\frac{x}{5} + \frac{y}{3} = 1$

f $5x + 3y = 7$
 $x + y = 2$

g $-5p - 7q = -\frac{43}{5}$
 $-15p - 28q = -\frac{157}{5}$

9 Solve the following system of equations:

$$2x + 5y = 9$$

$$x + y = 10$$

and find the value of each of the following expressions:

a $x + 4y$

b $7x + 10y$

c $3y$